A Apex CRM

Apex CRM — User guide

How to sign in, find your way around, and run your clients, sales, projects and invoices.

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1. What Apex CRM is

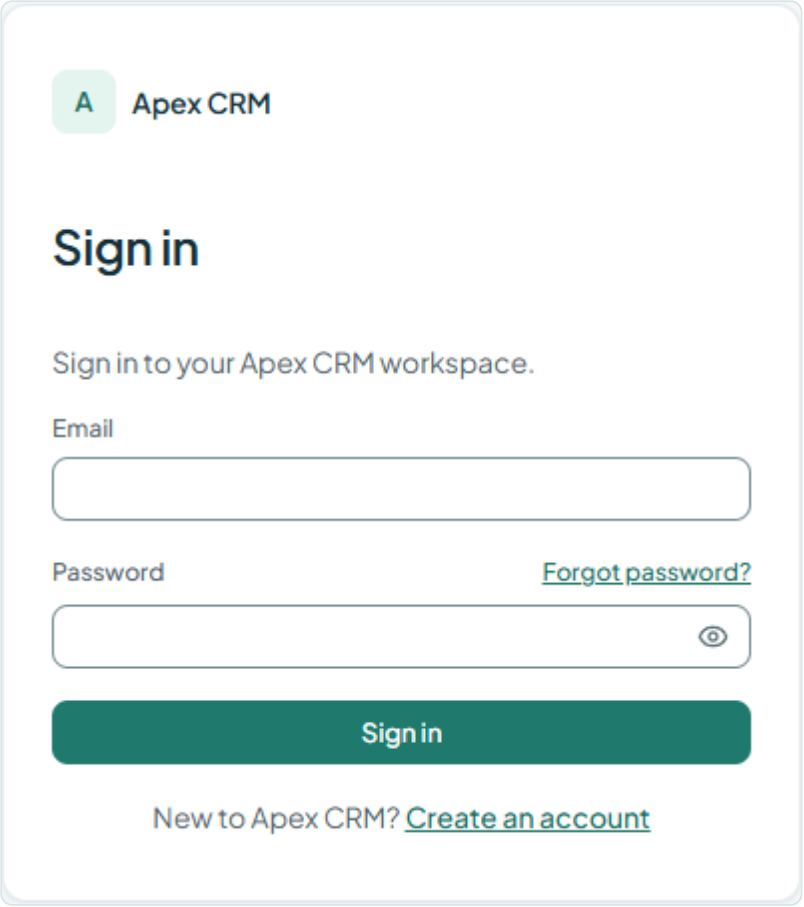
Apex CRM is a website you open in any browser — on a computer, a tablet or a phone. There is nothing to install. It keeps everything about your business in one place: your clients, the deals you are chasing (leads), the projects you deliver, your tasks, quotations, invoices and the payments you receive.

It works in English, French and Arabic. Arabic screens read from right to left. You can switch language at any time from the top bar.

- Clients — the companies and people you work with.
- Leads — possible deals, from first contact until you win or lose them.
- Projects and Tasks — the work you deliver and who does what by when.
- Quotations and Invoices — documents you send; payments you record against them.
- Follow-ups — calls, emails and meetings you must not forget.
- Reports — how much you invoiced and collected, who pays late, why deals are lost.

2. Your account

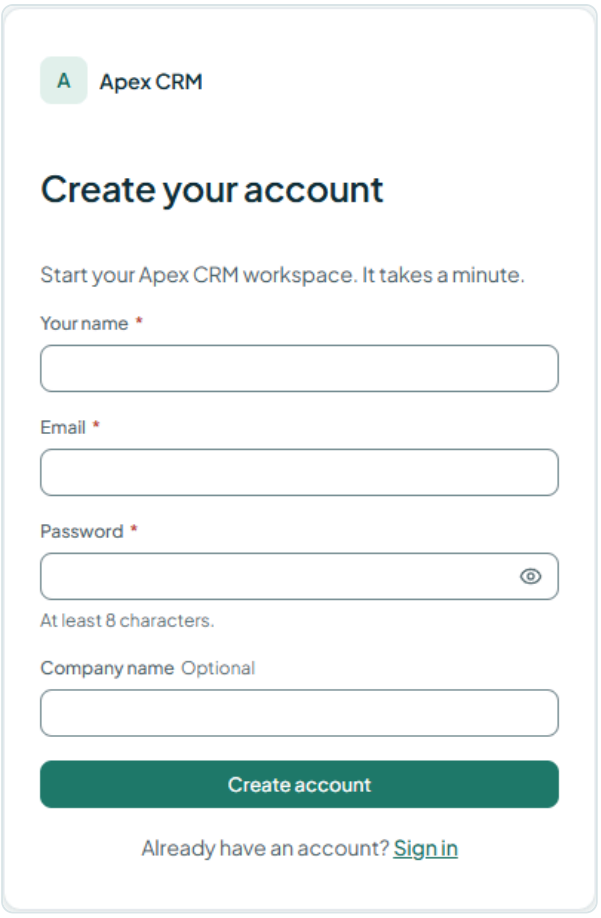
Open the address of your Apex CRM (for example http://localhost:3000 on your own computer). If you are not signed in, you see the sign-in page.



The sign-in page.

Create an account

1. On the sign-in page, click “Create an account”.
2. Type your name, your email and a password of at least 8 characters. The company name is optional.
3. Click “Create account”. You are signed in straight away, in a new, empty workspace that belongs to you.
4. We send you an email “Confirm your email”. Open it and click the button. Until you do, a yellow bar at the top of the app reminds you (it has a “Resend link” button).



Creating an account.

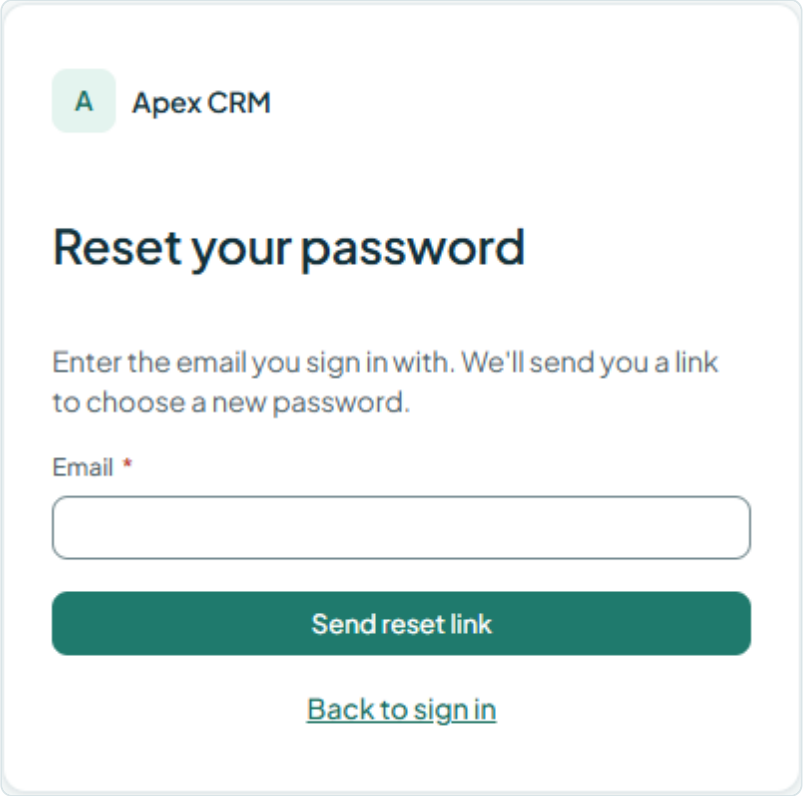
> **Tip**
> Confirming your email matters: it is how you get back in if you forget your password.

Sign in with Google

When Google sign-in is switched on (see chapter 13), the sign-in and sign-up pages show “Continue with Google”. Click it, choose your Google account, and you are in. If you already have an Apex CRM account with the same email, Google signs you into that same account.

Forgot your password?

1. On the sign-in page, click “Forgot password?”.
2. Type the email you sign in with and click “Send reset link”.
3. Open the email “Reset your Apex CRM password” and click “Choose a new password”. The link works once and only for 60 minutes.
4. Type your new password twice and click “Save password and sign in”. You are signed in, and every other computer or phone that was signed in to your account is signed out.



Asking for a reset link.

Tip

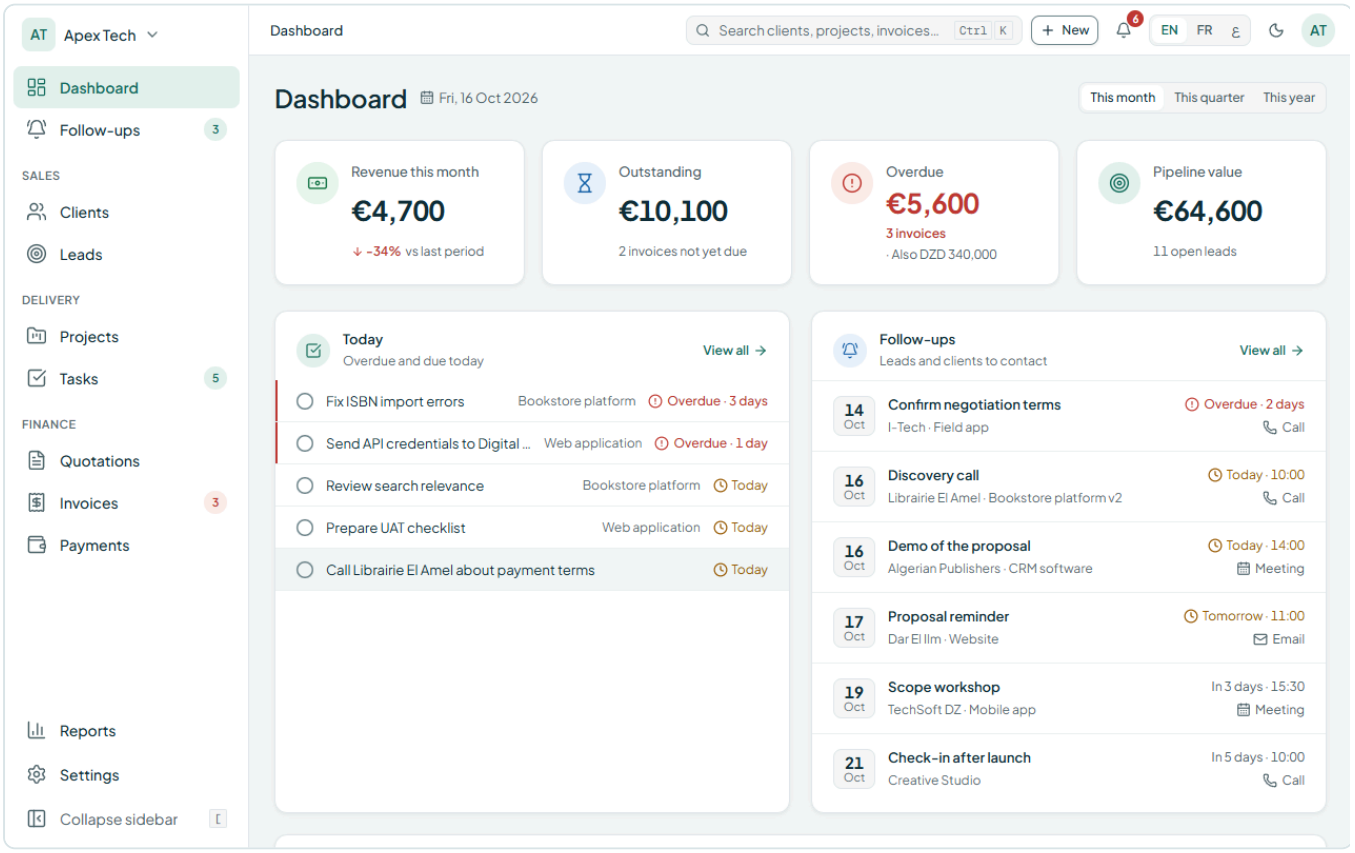
For your safety the page always says “If an account exists for this email, we sent a link” — it never tells strangers who has an account. No email? Check the spam folder, wait a few minutes, then use “Send the link again”. You can ask for up to 3 links every 15 minutes; only the newest link works.

Sign out: click your initials in the top-right corner, then “Log out”.

Good to know

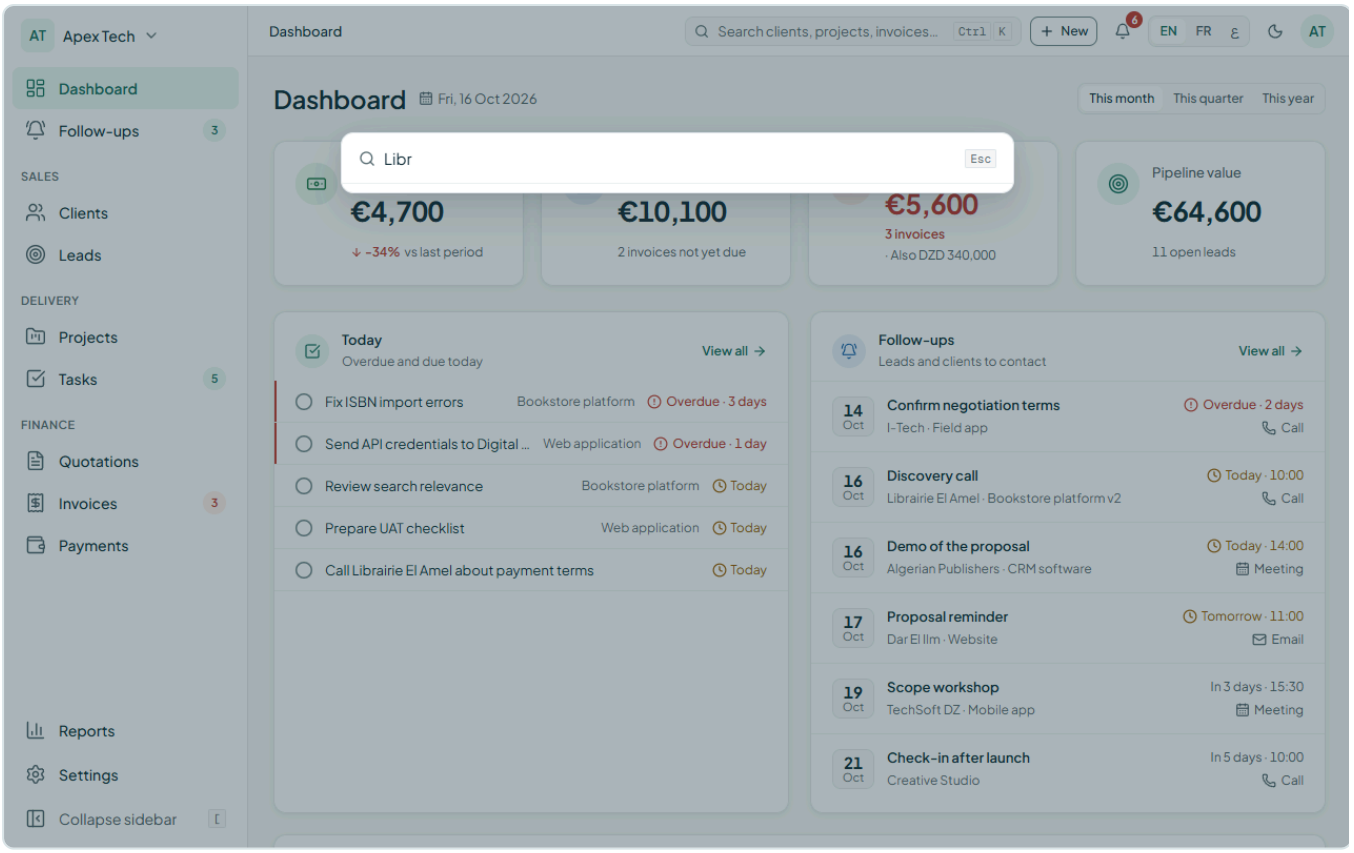
After 5 wrong passwords in a row, signing in to that email is paused for 15 minutes. Use “Forgot password?” instead of guessing.

3. Finding your way around



The dashboard, with the sidebar on the side and the top bar.

- Sidebar: every module, grouped into Sales, Delivery and Finance. Small numbers show what needs you (tasks due, overdue invoices). Press [to fold it into a thin rail and get more room.
- Search (top bar, or Ctrl+K): type any client, project or invoice number and press Enter to open it.
- "+ New": create a client, lead, project, invoice or task from anywhere.
- Bell: notifications. Moon/Sun: dark or light theme. EN / FR / ع: language.
- Your initials: settings and Log out.
- On a phone, the sidebar hides behind the ☰ button at the top-left (top-right in Arabic).

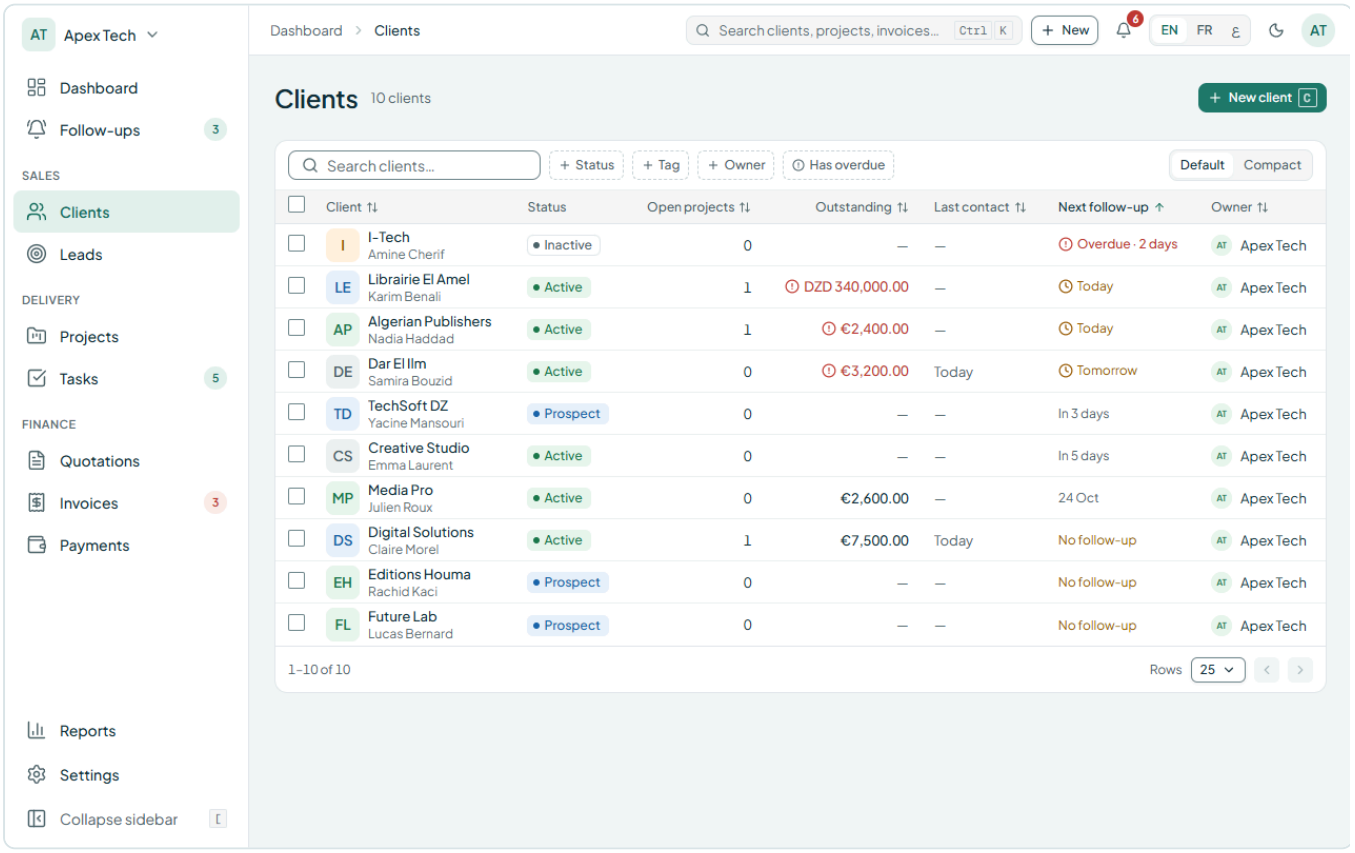


Search with Ctrl+K.

4. Dashboard — your day at a glance

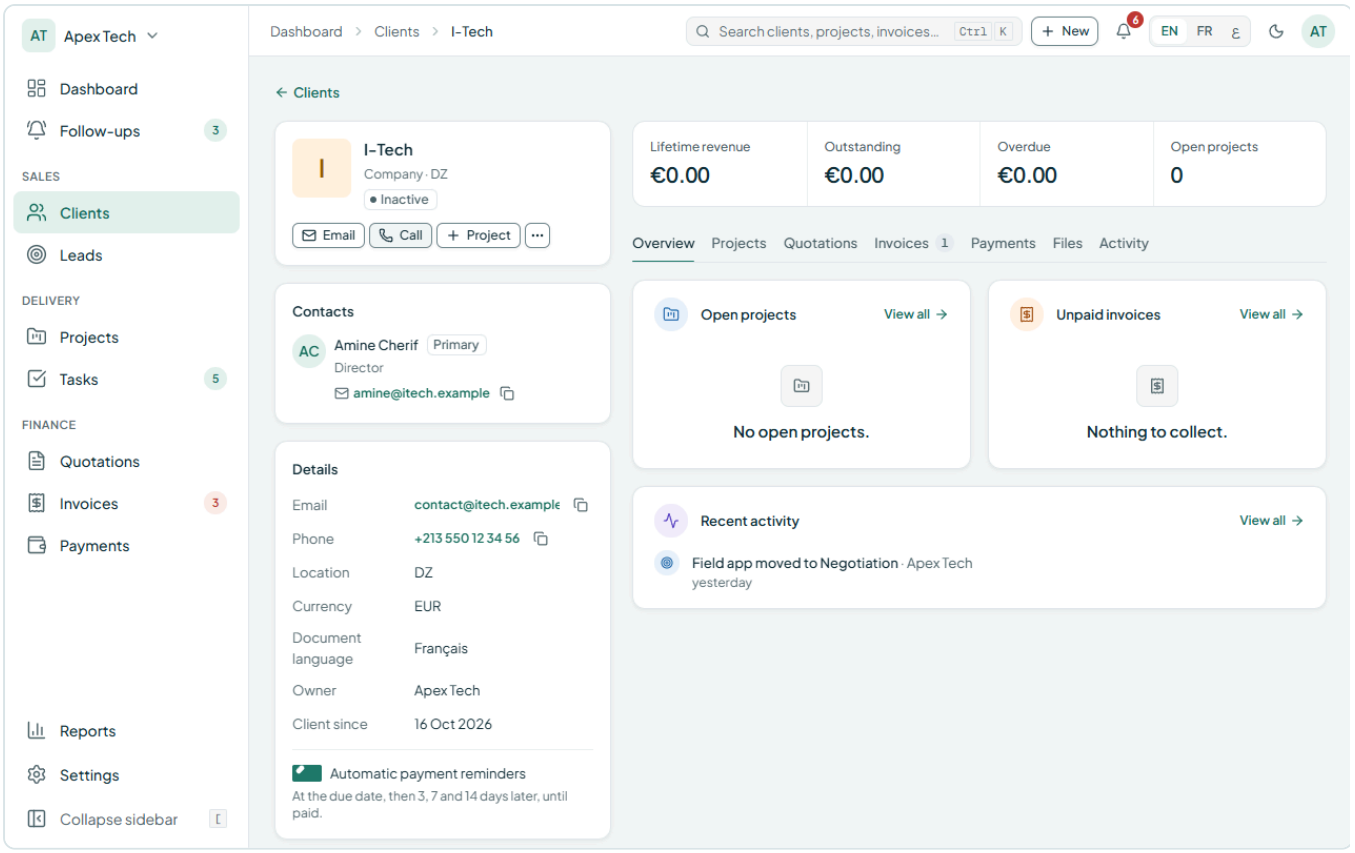
- The four numbers at the top: revenue this month, money outstanding, overdue invoices, and the value of open deals. Click one to see the list behind it. Switch the period with This month / This quarter / This year.
- Today: your tasks due today — tick the box to mark one done (Undo appears for a few seconds).
- Follow-ups: who you promised to call or email.
- Overdue invoices: with a “Send reminder” button for each.
- Charts: invoiced vs collected, and your pipeline by stage. “View as table” shows the same numbers as a table.

5. Clients



The client list.

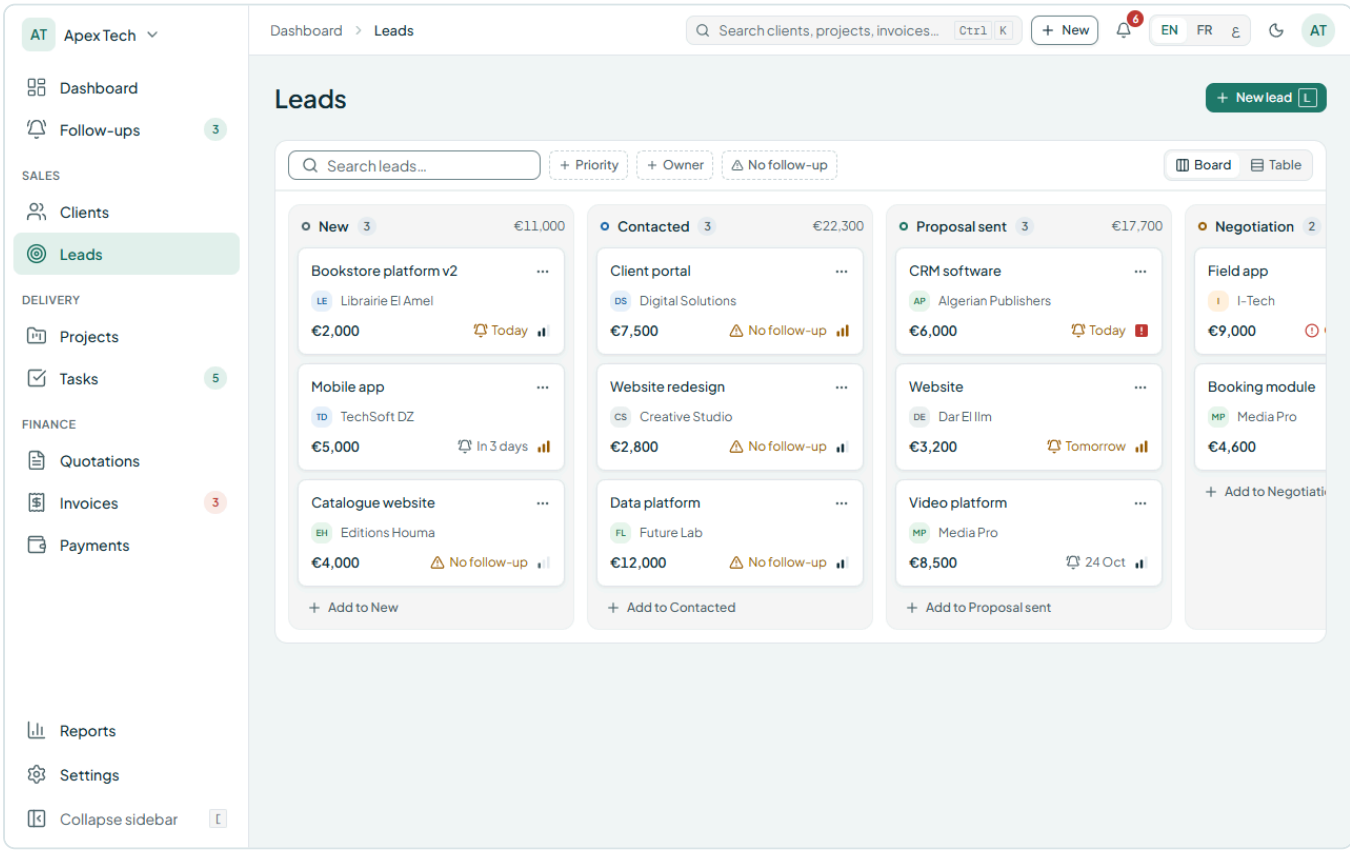
1. Click “New client” (or press C anywhere). Fill in the name and the details you have, then save.
2. Use the search box and the filter chips (Status, Tag, Owner, Has overdue) to narrow the list. Click a column title to sort.
3. Tick clients to export them to a CSV file or archive them (Undo is offered).
4. Click a client to open its profile.



A client profile.

The profile shows contacts and details on the side, key numbers on top (billed, paid, outstanding), and tabs for projects, invoices, quotations and the activity timeline. In Activity you can log a call, an email, a meeting or a note — it stays in the client's history. Plan the next follow-up from the same place.

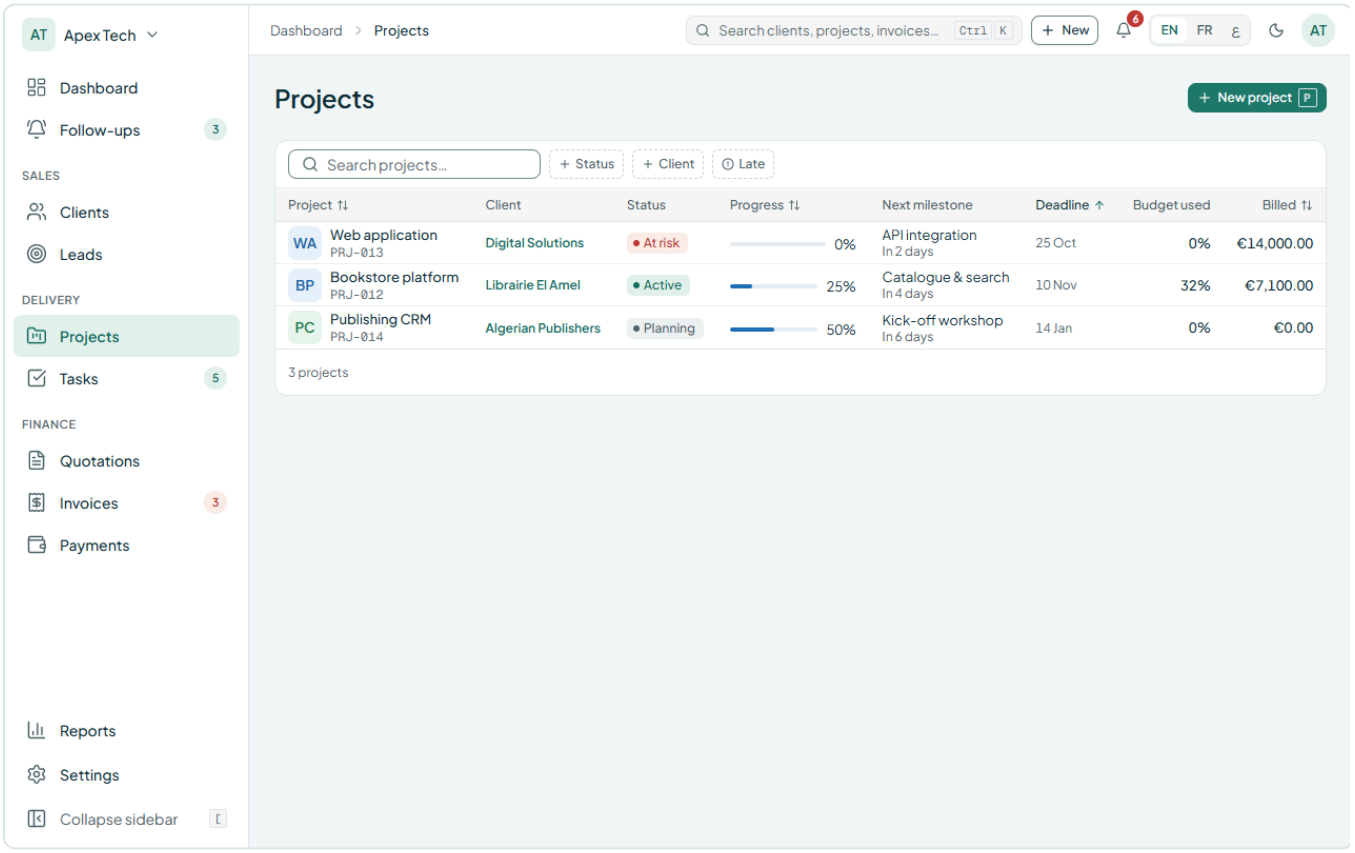
6. Leads — your sales pipeline



The lead board: one column per stage.

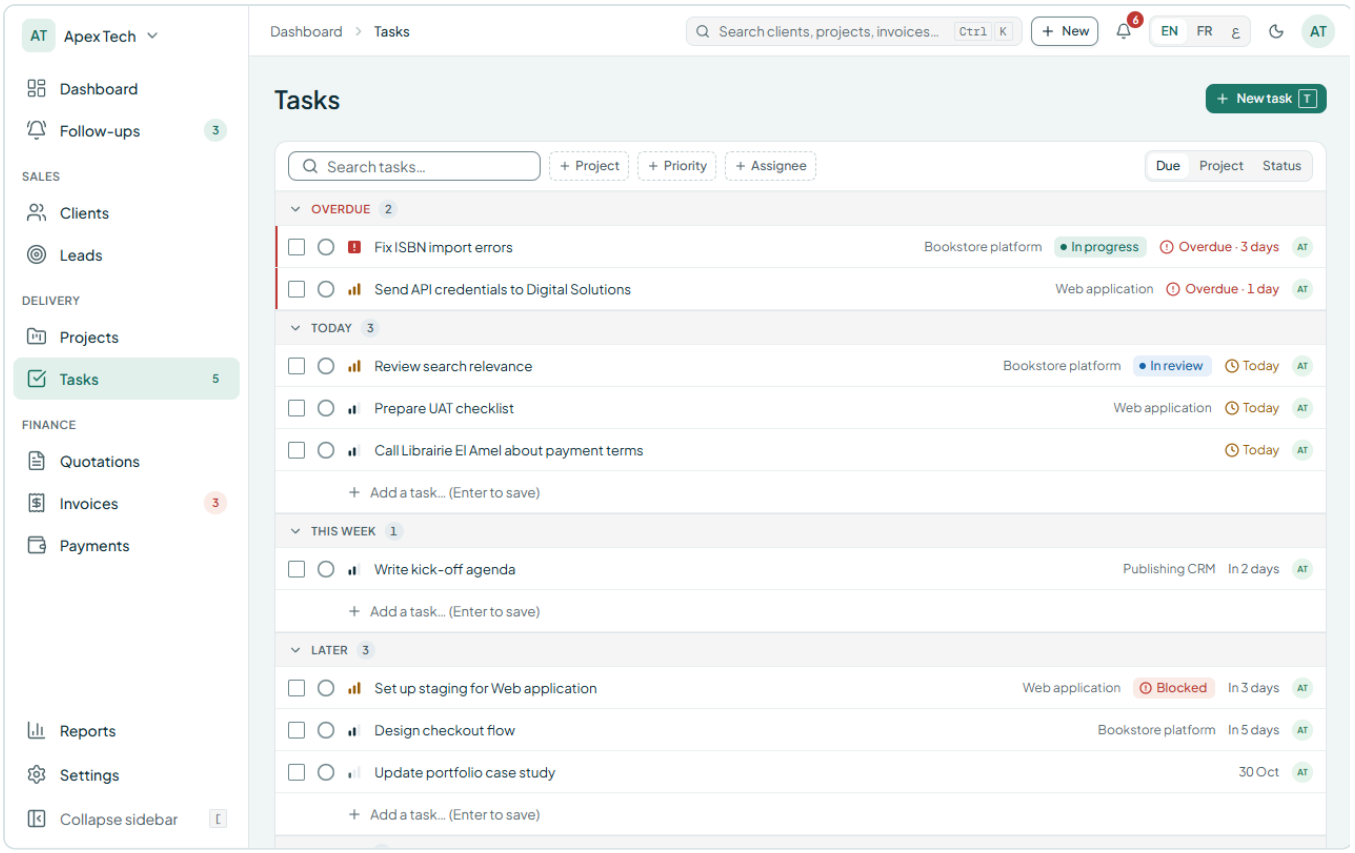
1. Click “New lead” (or press L). Give it a title, the client or prospect, an estimated value and a priority.
2. Move a lead to the next stage by dragging its card to another column. With the keyboard: focus the card and use the “Move to” menu.
3. When you win a deal, mark it as won: type the final value, then choose “Convert to project” or create a quotation straight away.
4. When you lose one, mark it as lost and pick the reason. Reports later show why deals are lost.
5. Prefer a list? Switch the view from Board to Table.

7. Projects and tasks



The project list with progress and budget.

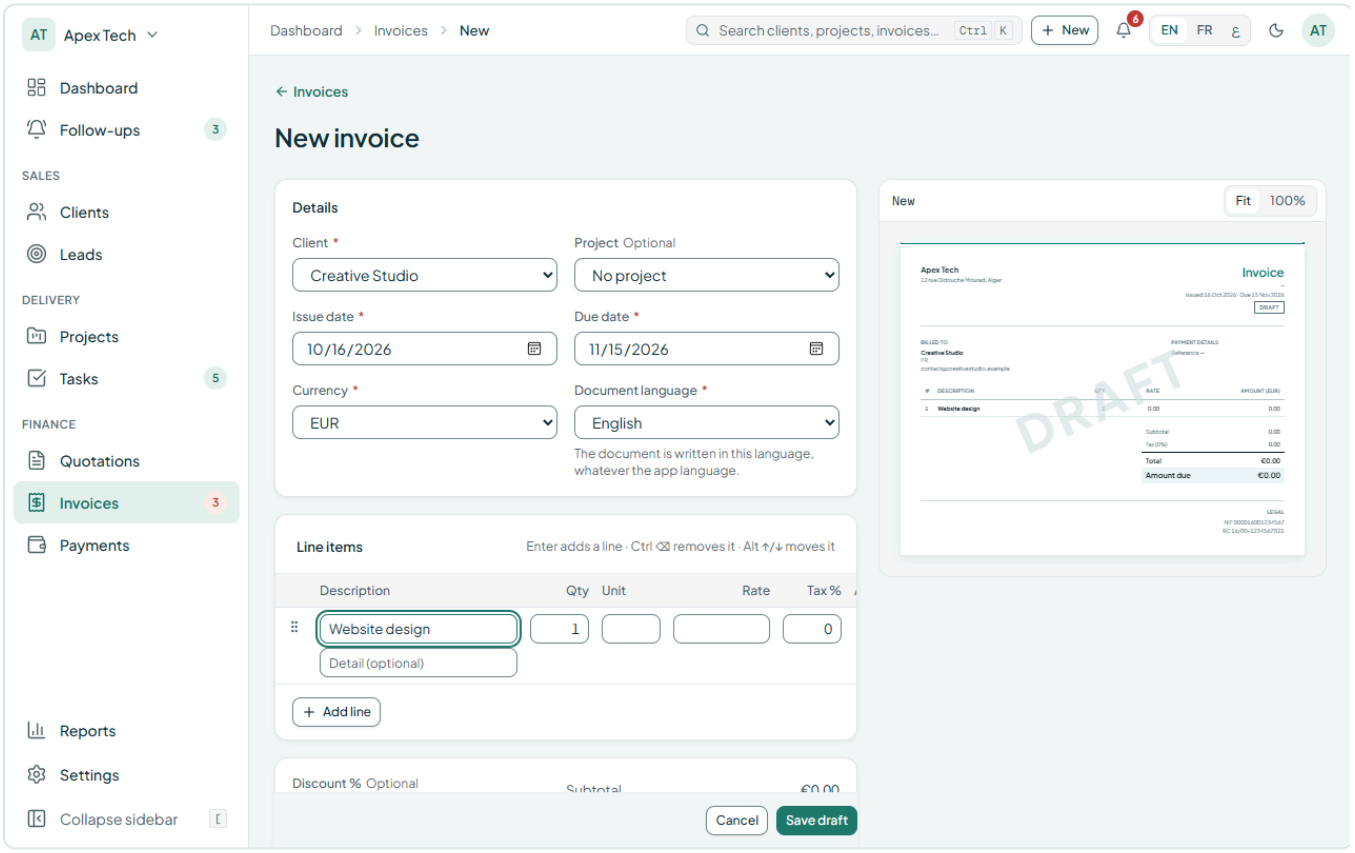
Each project has a code (PRJ-001…), a client, a deadline, a budget and milestones. The list shows progress, the next milestone and how much is billed. Open a project to change its status, add milestones and tasks, and bill milestones with “Create invoice”.



Tasks grouped by due date.

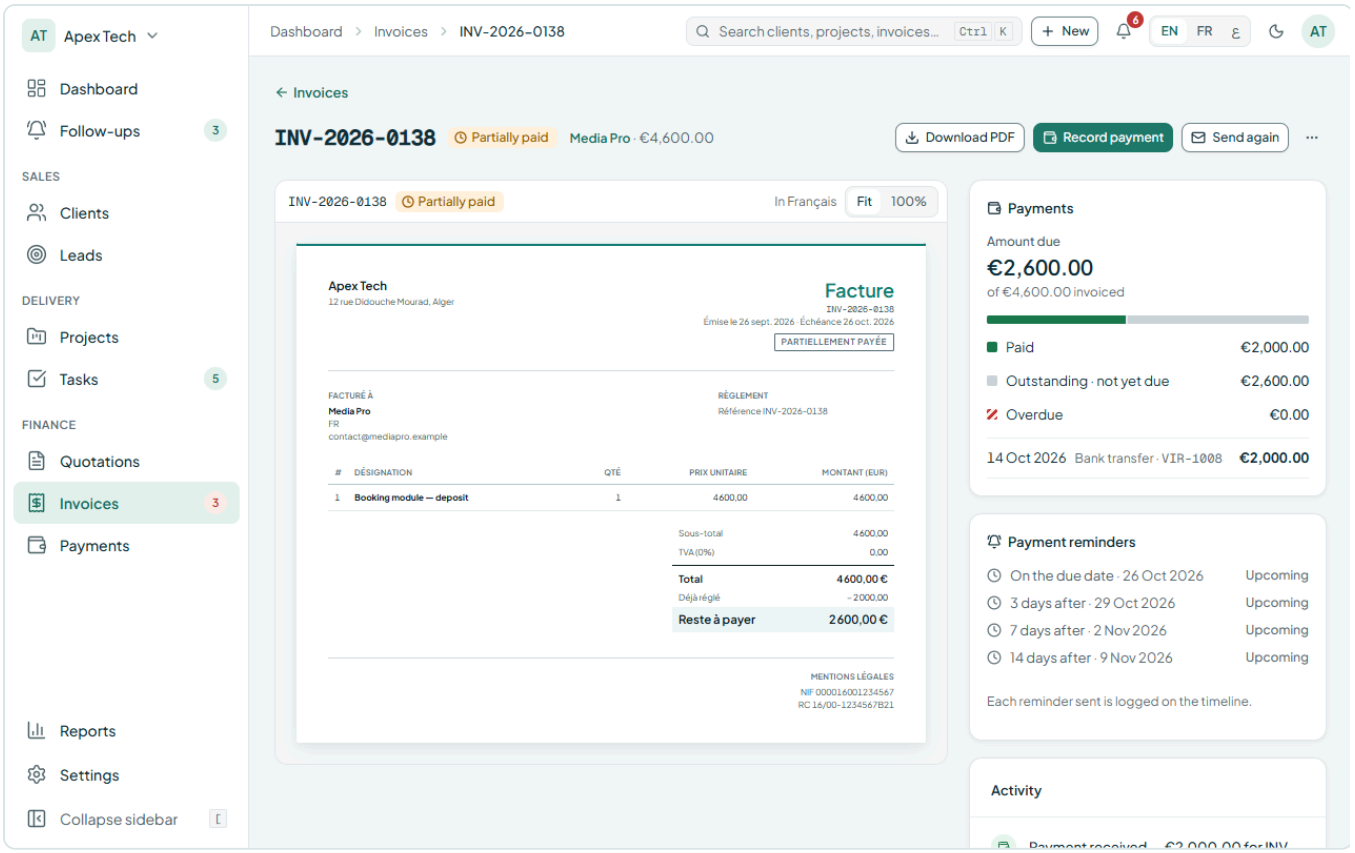
1. Tasks are grouped by due date: Overdue, Today, This week, Later, No date. Change “Group by” to see them by project or status.
2. Tick the circle to complete a task. Type in the “Add a task…” line of any group and press Enter to add one quickly.
3. Select several tasks to move their due date or mark them done together.
4. Click a task to edit it or delete it (Undo is offered).

8. Quotations and invoices



The invoice editor: lines on the left, live preview on the right.

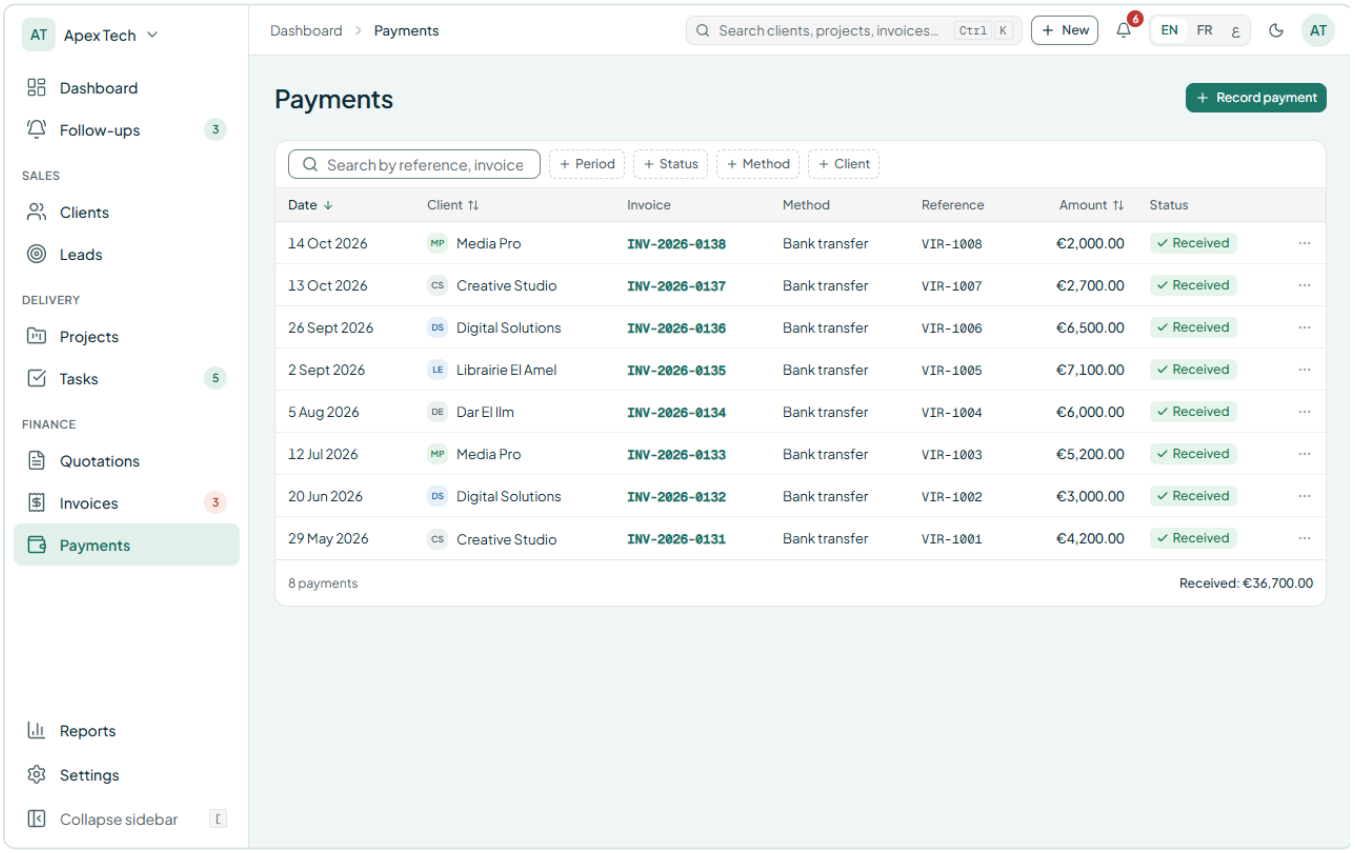
1. Click “New invoice” (or press I), or “New quotation” in Quotations.
2. Choose the client. Add lines: description, quantity, unit price, discount and tax. Press Enter to add the next line. Totals update as you type.
3. The preview shows the real document, in the client's document language (French, English or Arabic).
4. Save the draft, then click “Send”. Your email program opens with the message ready; the invoice is marked as sent.
5. “Download PDF” prints the document; choose “Save as PDF” in the print window.



An invoice after it was sent, with its payment summary.

- Numbers are automatic: INV-2026-0001 for invoices, Q-2026-001 for quotations.
- A quotation can be marked Accepted or Declined, and converted to an invoice in one click.
- An invoice becomes Overdue by itself after its due date. “Send reminder” logs a reminder.
- Void an invoice instead of deleting it; the number stays used, so your numbering has no gaps.

9. Payments and reminders

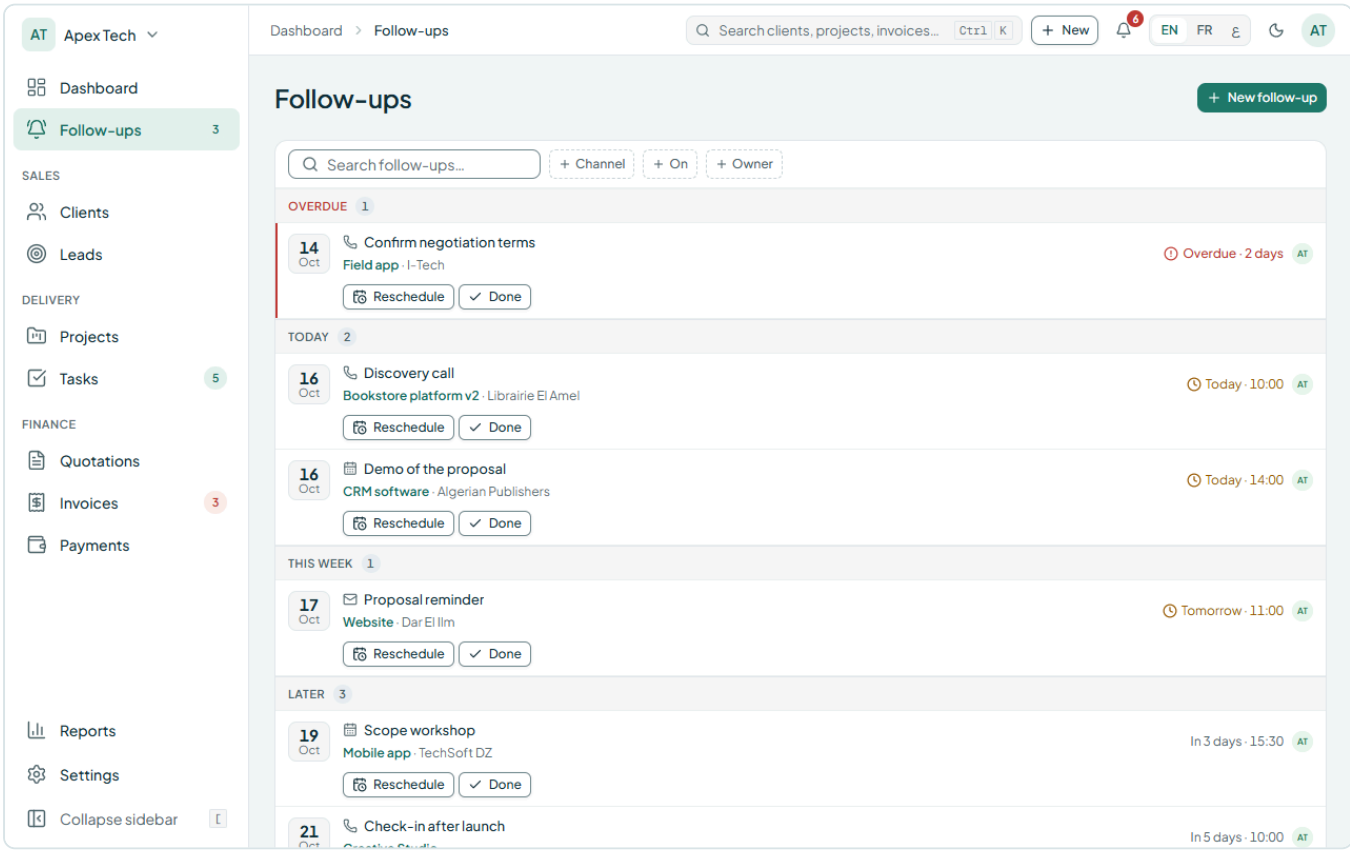


All payments, with filters.

1. Open an invoice and click “Record payment”, or use “Record payment” in Payments.
2. Type the amount, the date and the method (transfer, cash, cheque, card…). A partial amount leaves the rest outstanding; the invoice shows “Partially paid”.
3. When everything is paid the invoice turns “Paid” by itself.

Every unpaid invoice shows its reminder schedule: on the due date, then 3, 7 and 14 days later. You can switch reminders off for a client who prefers a phone call.

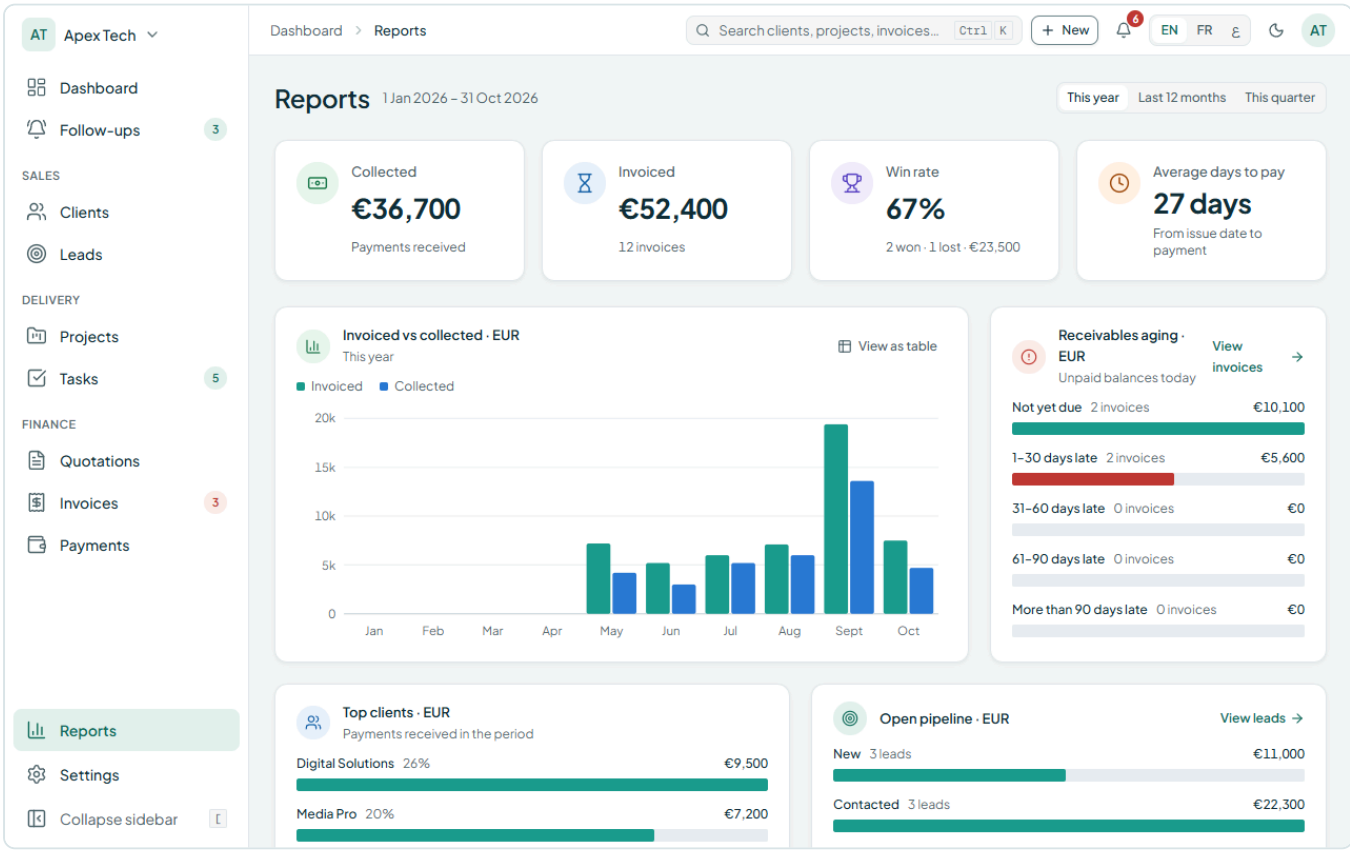
10. Follow-ups



Follow-ups grouped by due date.

A follow-up is a promise: “call Karim on Thursday”. Create one with “New follow-up” or from a client or lead. When it is done, record the outcome and plan the next one in the same step. Late follow-ups stay at the top until you deal with them.

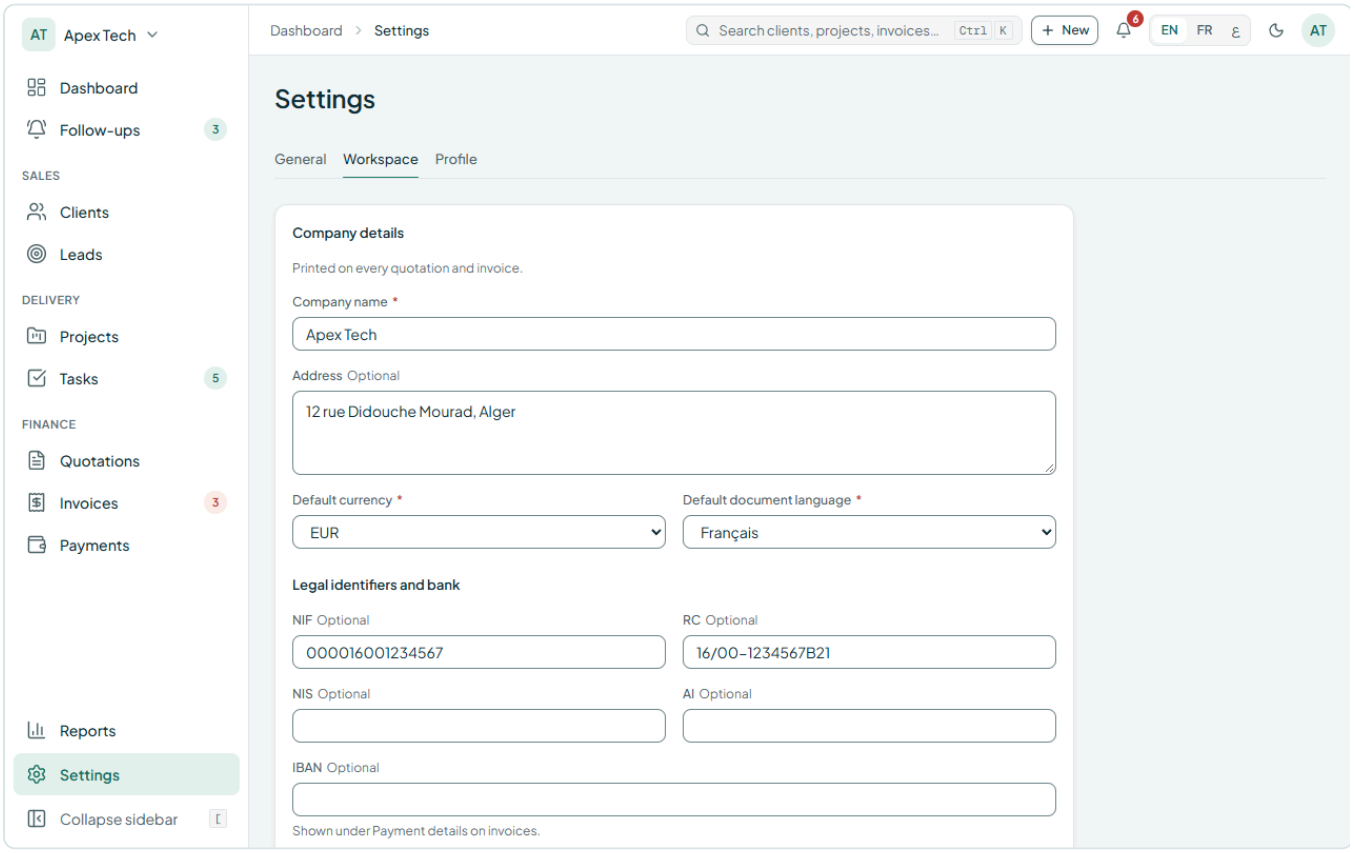
11. Reports



Reports.

- Collected, invoiced, win rate and average days to get paid, for the period you choose.
- Month by month chart of invoiced vs collected.
- Receivables aging: how much is 1–30, 31–60, 61–90 or 90+ days late. Click a bar to open those invoices.
- Top clients, open pipeline by stage, and the reasons deals were lost.

12. Settings



Settings › Workspace: details printed on your documents.

- General: language, theme (light, dark, or follow the computer) and sidebar.
- Workspace (owner only): company name, address, NIF, RC, NIS, AI, IBAN, default currency and document language. These appear on every quotation and invoice.
- Profile: your name. Your email is shown but cannot be changed here.

Shortcut	What it does
`Ctrl + K · /`	Search and jump anywhere
`G → D / C / L / P / T / I`	Press G, then the letter: Dashboard / Clients / Leads / Projects / Tasks / Invoices
`C · L · P · I · T`	New client, lead, project, invoice, task
`[`	Fold or unfold the sidebar
`Esc`	Close a window or menu

13. For the owner: switching on email and Google

These settings live in the file .env.local in the project folder (on the server, in its environment variables). After changing them, restart the app.

Email (needed for password reset and email confirmation)

1. Simplest: a Gmail account. In your Google Account, turn on 2-Step Verification, then open “App passwords” and create one named “Apex CRM”. Google shows 16 letters.
2. In .env.local set: SMTP_HOST=smtp.gmail.com, SMTP_PORT=465, SMTP_USER=your Gmail address, SMTP_PASS=the 16 letters (no spaces), MAIL_FROM="Apex CRM <your Gmail address>".
3. When the site is online, also set APP_URL to its public address (for example https://crm.yourcompany.com) so the links in emails point to it.
4. Restart, then test: sign out, use “Forgot password?” with your own email.

Tip

Gmail allows about 500 emails a day — plenty for password resets. For more, or to send from your own domain, use a service such as Brevo or Resend: they give you SMTP settings to paste in the same four lines.

Good to know

While SMTP_HOST is empty (on your own computer), no real email leaves: every email the app would send appears at http://localhost:3000/api/dev/mail. On a live server without email settings, “Forgot password?” shows an error instead of pretending.

Google sign-in (optional)

1. Open console.cloud.google.com, create a project, then APIs & Services › OAuth consent screen: choose External, fill in the app name and your email.
2. APIs & Services › Credentials › Create credentials › OAuth client ID › Web application.
3. Under “Authorised redirect URIs” add http://localhost:3000/api/auth/callback/google — and later the same with your public address.
4. Copy the Client ID and Client secret into .env.local as AUTH_GOOGLE_ID and AUTH_GOOGLE_SECRET, then restart. The “Continue with Google” button appears.

Tip

Keep .env.local private: it holds your database password, AUTH_SECRET and email password. It is never sent to GitHub.